

The Risk of Prolonged Psychiatric Admission Score (R-PPAS) Checklist

The R-PPAS is a 14-item risk stratification tool that uses information available at or shortly after admission to identify adult acute psychiatric admissions at risk of staying longer than 59 days, so that discharge planning can begin earlier. It was developed and externally validated in 4208 admissions across six adult acute wards in two English counties. It is intended to support, not replace, clinical judgement, and to prompt earlier planning rather than to influence decisions about whether a patient is ready for discharge.

Instructions: Select the primary diagnosis (maximum one) and check all social and risk factors that apply at or during admission. Sum the assigned points to calculate the total R-PPAS (minimum 0, maximum 7). A score of ≥ 3 exceeds the clinical cut-off for predicting prolonged admissions (>59 days) and should trigger early discharge planning interventions. Do not round the total: a score of 2.5 falls below the threshold.

Note: The score identifies admissions likely to be prolonged; it does not indicate that a longer stay is clinically inappropriate. A substantial proportion of patients require more than 59 days.

Step 1: Primary Diagnosis (Select ONE only)	Score
☐ Paranoid schizophrenia	+ 2.0
☐ Schizoaffective disorder	+ 2.0
☐ Bipolar disorder	+ 2.0
☐ Severe depression	+ 1.5
☐ Other psychosis	+ 1.0
☐ None of the above	0
Step 2: Social & Care Factors (Check ALL that apply)	
☐ Homelessness	+ 1.0
☐ Delayed care coordinator allocation (>2 weeks)	+ 1.0
Step 3: Risk Concerns (Check ALL that apply)	
☐ Self-neglect	+ 1.0
☐ Non-compliance/care disengagement	+ 1.0
☐ Aggression and violence	+ 1.0
☐ Falls risk	+ 1.0
☐ Drug or alcohol misuse	– 0.5
☐ Self-harm	– 0.5
☐ Accidental harm (outside the home)	– 0.5
Step 4: Total Score Calculation	
Total R-PPAS Points = _____	(Cap at 0 minimum, 7 maximum)
Step 5: Risk Stratification & Suggested Action	
☐ 0 – 2.5 Points: LOW RISK (Standard admission pathway)	
☐ 3 – 4.5 Points: MODERATE RISK (Clinical Cut-Off Exceeded: Initiate proactive discharge planning)	
☐ ≥ 5 Points: HIGH RISK (High priority for early resource allocation and intensive community transition planning)	